

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN AND FOR
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: [25-CA-10255]

DIVISION: [B]

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], Plaintiffs

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,

CLERK OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR, CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE

**AMENDED VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY
RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES**

Plaintiff Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], hereby amends his original Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees, filed on October 14, 2025 (E-Filed October 15, 2025), pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.190(a). This amendment is filed as a matter of course, as no responsive pleading has been served. The amendment adds defendants, updates factual allegations to reflect ongoing efforts to cover up attorney and judicial misconduct in the 13th Circuit as of November 12, 2025, (including non-responses to additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8), and reiterates the legal bases for relief including on Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420, and arguments for the extension of Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, to judicial records, at least where there is evidence of systemic corruption. This amended petition is brought pursuant to Rule 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch court and administrative records. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Plaintiff), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as

permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e). All allegations from the original petition are incorporated herein unless modified.

I. Introduction and Parties:

1. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a). This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (emphasizing that "a strong presumption of public access to the court's records exists" and closure is warranted only *upon specific findings* of necessity, with alternatives considered and restrictions as narrow as possible).
2. Plaintiff seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of judicial records unlawfully withheld by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and its officers. These records, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to judicial bias, corruption, and misconduct in the underlying family law case involving attorneys on both sides and the bench itself (24-DR-001150). The intentional lack of transparency has directly impacted the children's welfare with no legitimate state interest served. The only apparent motive for the initial, strategic production of documents and the more recent complete non-responsiveness is to cover for Courthouse (clubhouse) insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.
3. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these [governmental] institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003) Here, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given 13th Circuit representatives

misconduct in the case and motive to conceal damaging materials for no reason other than to avoid consequences for misconduct. Allegations of systemic misconduct demand scrutiny, and any claimed exemption must be "no broader than necessary to accomplish the stated purpose" with specificity, as required by Article I, Section 24(c). See also Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trs. of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851, 857 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013) (public records laws "liberally construed in favor of openness").

4. Plaintiff also seeks declaratory relief and attorney's fees under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) and any other basis under the law, including statutory, regulatory, and common law grounds. Although Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not directly apply to judicial branch records per Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691, 698 (Fla. 1995) (holding that "chapter 119 has no application to judicial records" but affirming that Rule 2.420 "provides the public access to judicial records required by article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution"), access remains independently mandated by the Constitution itself and Rule 2.420, which implement a presumption of openness where exemptions must be narrowly construed. Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444, 446 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (reiterating constitutional access to judicial records).
5. In balancing interests here—where high-level judicial misconduct threatens public trust and family welfare—the scales tip decisively toward disclosure, as "the burden of the party seeking closure [is] to prove that closure is necessary," with no reasonable alternative and the least restrictive means employed. Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118. Here, the 13th Circuit has fought transparency at every step, causing great damage to this family and public perception of Florida's judicial system. No prior motion for determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(e) or (f) is required for this mandamus action, as the denials are administrative in nature and not based on a court order determining confidentiality.

II. Jurisdiction and Venue

6. This Court has jurisdiction under Article V, §5 of the Florida Constitution, §26.012, Florida Statutes, and Rule 2.420(l)(2) for mandamus review of access denials by judicial branch custodians.
7. Venue (prior to the Court's consideration of the corruption and conflicts involved) is proper in Hillsborough County under §47.011 and Rule 2.420, because the defendants reside here and the cause of action primarily accrued here.

III. Parties

8. Plaintiff Christopher Hanson is a licensed Florida attorney acting on his own behalf and acting as attorney and next friend for his minor children, who are residents of Florida and have a direct interest in the requested judicial records, as they pertain to their welfare in the underlying family law case.
9. Defendant Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court is the judicial branch entity subject to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420, responsible for maintaining and disclosing judicial records with custodial duties over the Circuit's Court and Administrative records.
10. Defendant Court Administrator/Clerk of the Court for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is the entity responsible for custodial duties over judicial records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
11. Defendant Gina Justice, former Court Administrator, recently left her employment at the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and no replacement has been named.
12. Defendant Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella is the Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, a public officer who oversees administrative operations, including records management, and serves as custodian under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
13. Defendant Judge Kelly Ayers is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
14. Defendant Judge Matthew Felix is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3), including those related to emergency filings and recusal in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
15. Defendant Mike Moore is the Public Information Officer for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, involved in processing public records requests.

IV. Relevant Facts:

16. Plaintiff submitted multiple requests for records including several formal letters (Docket #6, Exhibit A, pp. 3–12) to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit between July 24, 2025, and September 4, 2025, seeking access to:
 - Judicial disqualification and recusal records and associated documents and communications

- Administrative and all other communications regarding the GAL issue including Judge Ayers' request for a summary and Husband's objection to excusing Attorney Davis from drafting the summary.
 - Transcripts and filings referenced in public proceedings
 - Email and text communications of Judges Kelly Ayers and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to this case including those related to scheduling, objections, and disqualification/recusal.
 - Visual and audio recordings of specified hearings, primarily the April 4, 2025 hearing, offered by Judge Ayers as part of a lie/threat made on the formal transcript.
17. The Court Administrator's response on August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14), confirmed the existence of records satisfying these requests, acknowledging responsive communications but providing only partial, redacted productions without affidavits confirming complete searches or explanations for omissions. Here, the Court administrator's responses confirm sufficient identification of my legal right to clearly defined information, the Court identified and confirmed its availability (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14). However, in follow-up correspondence on October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, p. 20), Plaintiff highlighted the complete absence of any records relating to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings in the records produced, despite the Administrator's confirmation of their existence—indicating deliberate withholding.
18. The evidence demonstrates defendants' intent to subvert the truth and conceal evidence of judicial misconduct. (Docket #6, 10, 11). The Court administrator failed to produce the requested records (relating to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings prior to and during which, the Court obviously and severely violated plaintiff's due process rights) while providing voluminous records never requested (communications associated with all hearings not referenced in Plaintiff's requests).
19. The Court failed to respond at all to several questions and attempts to investigate the obvious failures to cooperate in good faith with these public records requests. Docket #6, p. 20-24. No court order determining confidentiality of these records has been issued or provided to Plaintiff. This failure contravenes the presumption of transparency, especially amid credible, unrefuted allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit. Given the Public Interest in uncovering systemic corruption, any exemption must be narrowly tailored (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of

Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013), stressing that public records laws are to be liberally construed in favor of openness).

20. Plaintiff received responses full of tedious unrequested information while the 13th Circuit sneakily concealed the evidence actually requested and relevant to plaintiff while the Court offered purported justification for withholding the specific video at issue that will show Judge Ayers demonstrating obvious bias in open Court, lying about it, and then offering to get the video in a threatening manner. (Docket #6, 10, 11). Correspondence from Gina Justice, Court Administrator, dated August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, pp. 13–15), September 4, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit C, p. 16), and September 8, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit D, p. 17). The Court acknowledged the existence of responsive records, but continued the pattern of clubhouse corruption in concealing the relevant evidence that would expose insider misconduct. There is nothing in the responsive documents from the 13th Circuit that constitutes a formal determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). The Court confirmed the existence of relevant evidence while failing to justify deviation from the presumption of openness, particularly given concerns of judicial misconduct that heighten the public interest in transparency (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118, requiring overriding public necessity for closure).
21. These responses were inadequate and failed to address key concerns, including the selective omission of materials Plaintiff requested for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings. Instead, Ms. Justice produced only voluminous, unrequested records for unrelated proceedings, suggesting an intent to obscure the concealment of evidence of systemic misconduct and corruption in the 13th Circuit. (Docket #6, p. 13-22).
22. The September 8, 2025 letter from Ms. Justice denied access to the April 4, 2025 video recording referencing the confidential nature of Court surveillance video, without ever identifying the April 4 video as coming from the surveillance system. The Court administrator refused to acknowledge Judge Ayers' offering the video on the record, raising concerns about inconsistent treatment, open and obvious bias, and concealment of Public Records to avoid consequences within the Circuit Clubhouse. This denial is administrative and reviewable by mandamus under Rule 2.420(l). The confidentiality referenced lacks the narrow tailoring required for any exemption amid allegations of high-level misconduct in the 13th Circuit (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1013-14, mandating specific findings to overcome the presumption of access).

23. Plaintiff has exhausted all informal remedies and administrative channels, including follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). Defendants never responded to any of the follow-up requests for documents or explanations from September 9, 2025 forward besides an email from Moore acknowledging receipt and ensuring processing in a “reasonable” time. As of November 12, 2025, no further responses or productions have been received, exacerbating the ongoing harm.

24. On October 14, 2025, Plaintiff submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 to Defendants, seeking records directly related to the ongoing misconduct in Case No. 24-DR-001150 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including:

- Request 6: Handling of correspondence with Chief Judge Sabella's office, including emails/letters from January 22, February 12, March 11, August 13, and August 16, 2025, regarding ethical violations by attorney Scott Davis and Judge Ayers' bias/cover-up (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-3).
- Request 7: Communications involving Judge Felix and his assistants about Plaintiff or the case, including emergency filings (Docket Nos. 246, 245, 233, 232, 230, 210, 209, 181) and post-recusal correspondence (Addendum Composite, pp. 4-5).
- Request 8: Judge Ayers' disqualification records/complaints from January 1, 2020, to present, including those related to GAL issues or the Ayo and Iken law firm (Addendum Composite, pp. 6-7).

25. These requests received only a form acknowledgment email on October 14, 2025, with no substantive response, production, timeline, or explanation for delays (Addendum Composite, pp. 8-12, including follow-ups on October 27, 2025 and November 12, 2025, demanding timely compliance. This total silence contrasts with partial responses to earlier requests, suggesting a more direct approach to the Court's obstruction efforts. In their completely unlawful efforts to avoid consequences for the clubhouse insiders guilty of severe misconduct and directly responsible for serious harm to a Florida family, the Court's current actions demonstrate an intentional strategy to subvert the truth to cover for bad judicial actors even at the expense of the citizens they've sworn to serve. The Court has completely failed to offer any materials sought in the most recent requests (e.g., Sabella's non-responsiveness, Felix's involvement, Ayers' disqualifications), further evidencing bad faith and constructive denial.

26. Ongoing failures include:

- Intentional concealment of records relating to due process violations and bias associated with the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings and the April 4, 2025 video, all with no good faith basis under the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420.
- No explanation for the Court's concealment and/or lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, which raise concerns about irregular proceedings and concealment given the existence of emails surrounding less controversial matters.
- No clarification on how "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing (Docket #6, Docket #198), whether the camera recording that footage is part of an actual security system, and why no similar footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Refusal to provide any information by email, despite repeated requests, leading to inefficiencies such as Plaintiff's September emails and the Court's September 4, 2025 letter crossing in the mail. This reliance on U.S. Mail appears deliberate to delay access and violates the intent of Rule 2.420 for prompt disclosure.
- No written explanations with specific citations for any withholdings even with the detailed questions posed.
- No response to requests for affidavits describing search methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices) to confirm completeness.

27. Defendants' complete non-response to these specific concerns and requests, combined with the partial responses (raising significant concerns about strategic withholding/concealment of specific materials of relevance), provides further evidence of bias, bad faith, and systemic corruption. There is an undeniable pattern where 13th Circuit "Clubhouse" members are circling the wagons to protect fellow insiders, in violation of public access rights under Rule 2.420. Such actions undermine the presumption of transparency, especially when misconduct at the highest levels is at stake, requiring strict scrutiny and narrow tailoring of any restrictions (see Rhea, 109 So. 3d at 857).

28. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family. The October 9, 2025 email (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24) explicitly stated: "The ongoing and intentional concealment of evidence critical to my case... is causing ongoing and increasing damage to my children and my health. I do not believe there's any good faith basis to conceal the evidence identified nor even offer any clarification

regarding the video evidence. I have real concerns about the veracity of some of the representations and the court's failure to even confirm devices searched."

29. Defendants' failure to respond since their September 8, 2025 letter aside from the form response, demonstrates active concealment and bad faith, particularly in light of the pre-suit notice and the problem with misconduct, corruption, and dishonesty in the underlying case.
30. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is acting in bad faith, as evidenced by the deliberate pattern of delays, non-responses, and strategically incomplete disclosures that seem to protect Judge Ayers, attorney Scott Davis, and other insiders by concealing extensive evidence that would cause the Court and the bar embarrassment and likely more significant discipline. This pattern heightens the need for transparency to expose misconduct at the highest levels, as the presumption favors disclosure unless narrowly justified (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 119).
31. The singular issue in the underlying case (24-DR-001150) is Husband's discovery efforts given Wife's concealment of marital assets at the time the parties entered a post-marital agreement without counsel. Attorney Scott Davis, representing Wife, proceeded with a legal strategy to delay, harass, burden, and obstruct Husband's access to obviously discoverable and critically relevant financial discovery, in direct violation of the Florida Bar Rules.
32. Judge Ayers actively assisted Wife and her attorney's obstruction strategies, suppressed evidence of obvious ethical misconduct from multiple attorneys, all to Husband's detriment, and actively sought to advance Wife's clearly retaliatory litigation (e.g., Docket #6, Exhibit G, pp. 25–83, detailing procedural irregularities, suppression of discovery, and failure to address ethical violations; Docket #6, Exhibit H, pp. 84–170, correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella).
33. Plaintiff sought assistance from the Chief Judge on numerous occasions as he consistently ignored the gross misconduct occurring in the Court he's sworn to oversee. (Docket #6, p. 84-170).
34. With respect to requested Court communications on the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings (Docket #6, p. 3-4, 7-8), Ms. Gina Justice, as Court administrator, intentionally concealed relevant evidence of judicial misconduct while actively burdening Plaintiff with irrelevant and unrequested documents. (Docket #6, 10, 11).
35. The Court Administrator not only failed to comply with the Court's duties under Rule 2.420 and the Florida constitution, the evidence demonstrates intentional deceit

with the Court's voluminous response consisting of unrequested records with the relevant ones requested conspicuously absent. (Docket #6, 10, 11).

36. These actions underscore the need for unhindered public access to records to ensure accountability and strict compliance with the Court's duty to narrowly tailor any Court and administrative records withheld from production, aligning with the constitutional presumption of openness (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1014).
37. The Judicial system has clearly allowed ethical compliance to falter to a point where the events described herein are a reality causing active harm to citizens.
38. A "Fox guarding the hen house" style of oversight dominated proceedings to date in the 13th Circuit and the Public Records request process.
39. The Florida and Federal Constitutions demand transparency to restore public trust in the institution.

V. Legal Basis for Relief

40. Under Article I, §24 of the Florida Constitution, every person has a right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf, except with respect to records exempted pursuant to this section or specifically made confidential by the Constitution. This includes judicial branch records, with a strong presumption in favor of access (see Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988); see also Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004)).
41. Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 implements this constitutional right for judicial branch records, establishing procedures for access, exemptions, and review of denials through mandamus or other appropriate relief (Rule 2.420(l)). The rule presumes openness, and exemptions must be narrowly construed. The requested records are "court records" or "administrative records" under Rule 2.420(b)(1) and are not exempt under Rule 2.420(c) unless properly determined confidential, which has not occurred here. Given allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit, any claimed exemption must be justified with specificity and narrowly tailored to override the presumption (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013)).
42. While Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, did not apply to judicial branch records under Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), Plaintiff submits that the

level of corruption that's festered in the 13th Circuit under these facts require reassessing applicability of Chapter 119 to the Judiciary. Ake should be distinguished or reconsidered here, as the requested records (e.g., communications and videos) are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption. Nonetheless, relief is independently available under the Federal and Florida Constitutions and Rule 2.420.

43. Defendants' failure to produce records and respond to questions about obvious failure and concealment efforts violates Rule 2.420 and entitles Plaintiff to mandamus relief under Rule 2.420(l) and attorney fees and costs under relevant common law. The Defendants' asserted exemptions are invalid, intentionally misleading, and/or overly broad under Rule 2.420(c), as no specific basis was provided that fits the facts and documents at issue, and no court order determining confidentiality exists under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). (Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996), finding unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith warranting fees).
44. The presumption of transparency is particularly vital here to address concerns of judicial misconduct, requiring any withholding to be narrowly tailored (see Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, 840 So. 2d 1008 (Fla. 2003)). The non-responses to Requests 6-8 exemplify this pattern, violating the presumption of openness and shifting the burden to Defendants to justify exemptions (Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988)).
45. The intentional concealment and non-responses to specific inquiries (e.g., devices searched, explanations for lack of footage/communications) demonstrate unreasonable and intentional delay, bad faith, and a pattern of inserting inefficiency in an attempt to advance concealment efforts.
46. The September 8, 2025 response's exemption claim for the April 4, 2025 video is a last-ditch attempt to justify continuing concealment of evidence the Judge offered to provide, when she attempted to use the offer as a threat that might help restore her credibility. (Docket #6, Exhibit E, pp. 18–19) This claim does not meet the requirements for a confidentiality determination under Rule 2.420(d)(1)(B) or (e), failing the narrow tailoring requirement amid high-level misconduct concerns (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118).
47. It was immediately after Husband insisted on the record that Ayers follow through with her threat to produce the video when the concealment efforts started, and have now continued ever since. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). There are now

multiple layers of misconduct stemming largely from Defendants' efforts to assist Mr. Davis in his misconduct to conceal financial evidence and marital assets. Plaintiff is constitutionally entitled to the very transparency that has the change to restore justice for the Citizens of Hillsborough County.

48. Additionally and alternatively, Defendants' failure to respond to the October 9, 2025 email, which asserted "ongoing and intentional concealment" and fee entitlement, further evidences active bad faith. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24)
49. Plaintiff is entitled to declaratory relief for himself and on behalf of his minor children under Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, to order production of the materials, clarify the legal duties of the Defendants under Rule 2.420, and/or otherwise mandate compliance.
50. Plaintiff is entitled to attorney's fees under Rule 2.420, Chapter 86, and Common Law for Defendants' bad faith and unreasonable obstruction to accessing Public Records, including enhanced awards for bad faith based on the pattern of delays, obstruction, non-responses to follow-ups, and evidence of bias/concealment. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12 if Chapter 119 applies, or under common law/equity for bad faith conduct (see *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983)).
51. Mandamus is appropriate where a petitioner demonstrates (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief, (2) an indisputable legal duty on the part of the respondent to perform the act, and (3) the absence of any other adequate remedy at law. See *Huffman v. State*, 813 So. 2d 10, 11 (Fla. 2000). Plaintiff satisfies each element here largely based on admissions from the 13th Circuit Court administrator who responded to the first 5 requests, acknowledging the right, duty, and existence of responsive records. (Docket #6, pp. 13-17).
52. Plaintiff has a clear legal right to access judicial records under Article I, § 24 of the Florida Constitution and Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420, which establish a strong presumption of openness. Second, Defendants, as custodians of judicial and administrative records, have an indisputable legal duty to produce those records unless a valid, narrowly tailored exemption is established. No such exemption or confidentiality finding exists despite the Circuit's obvious efforts toward concealment of its systemic corruption. Plaintiff lacks any adequate alternative remedy, having exhausted informal and administrative channels without response, leaving mandamus as the only mechanism to compel compliance with critical constitutional and statutory duties.

VI. Certification/Declaration:

53. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the following is true and correct to the best of my knowledge:

- I am acting as attorney and next friend for my minor children, whose interests are directly affected by the withheld records in the underlying litigation wrought with corruption, harmful delays and intentional obstruction subverting Truth and Justice, all actively supported by the 13th Circuit Defendants.
- I submitted the public records requests attached as Docket #6, Exhibit A (pp. 3–12).
- I received the responses attached as Docket #6, Exhibit B (pp. 13–15), Exhibit C (p. 16), and Exhibit D (p. 17), and the September 15, 2025 acknowledgment email.
- I reference the transcript excerpts attached as Docket #6, Exhibit E (pp. 18–19), which document the Court’s acknowledgment of video footage and refusal to retrieve it.
- I submitted timely follow-up correspondence, including that included within the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore, attached as Docket #6, Exhibit F (pp. 20–24).
- I filed the motion to supplement the appellate record attached as Docket #6, Exhibit G (pp. 25–83) due to the video’s critical evidence to the underlying case, which documents bias through procedural irregularities (e.g., pp. 25–26, 32–33 on video offer and non-production; pp. 27–31 on ethical violations ignored).
- Some of the records sought pertain to judicial scheduling, recusal, and procedural communications in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
- The responses from the Court Administrator confirm the existence of responsive records without qualifying the public records sought under any exemptions.
- I have experienced retaliatory conduct following lawful public records requests, including unaddressed questions that independently raise further concerns over bias, corruption and ongoing cover-up attempts during plaintiff’s year and a half under the Court’s jurisdiction.
- The Court administrator (Docket #6, Exhibits B-D) failed to address follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. Specifically, Defendants concealed relevant evidence, pursued a strategy of burying Plaintiff in irrelevant, unrequested documents, and refused to offer explanations for lack of communications produced for requested hearings, December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025. The Defendants also specifically failed to qualify the April 4, 2025 hearing video under any exemption and refused Plaintiff’s requests for clarification on "security" video

existence only for April 4, 2025, whether the camera is part of a security system, and why no footage exists for other hearing dates if it's truly "security" footage.

- Judicial officers have obstructed access to records and failed to comply with access rights under Rule 2.420, as evidenced by the pattern of ignored ethical concerns detailed in Docket #6, Exhibits G and H (pp. 84–170). This non-response pattern further confirms the bias, concealment, and "13th Circuit Clubhouse" culture where all the "members" have circled their wagons to protect insiders, violating public access rights.
- I submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 on October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), and follow-ups, with no substantive response as of November 12, 2025, further evidencing bad faith.
- The exhibits provide solid unrefuted evidence supporting the 13th Circuit's failures, refusals, and intentional actions in violation of Plaintiff's due process rights.

Certified and executed on November 13, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson
Christopher Hanson
cahanson77@yahoo.com
727-409-5738

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court:

A. Issue a writ of mandamus under Rule 2.420(l) compelling Defendants to produce the following records immediately and without hearing, as time is of the essence:

- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant, (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the 12-13-24 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-1150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanso. Specifically, I'm requesting all of these materials from December 1, 2024, to December 20, 2024, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on December 13, 2024 (per Records request, pp. 3-4),
- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the January 9, 2025 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-11550, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah

Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, I am requesting all of these materials from December 21, 2024, to January 20, 2025, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on January 9, 2025.

- All visual and audio recordings of the April 4, 2025 hearing,
- All emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication sent or received by Judge Wendy J. DePaul, her judicial assistant, and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in or discussed the recusal in and/or all other documentation regarding Judge DePaul's involvement with Case No. 24-DR-001150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, all materials from April 1, 2025, to May 31, 2025, including communications with court staff, other judges, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about the recusal, the decision to recuse, or the issuance of the Order of Recusal dated April 28, 2025. This includes, but is not limited to, any internal memos, notes, drafts, or correspondence related to the recusal process.
- All communications regarding the April 7, 2025 request for summary of Wife's testimony and Husband's motion to strike
- All records responsive to Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 dated October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including handling of Sabella correspondence, Felix communications, and Ayers disqualification records.
- all public records related to the handling of concerns described in the letters and emails I sent to Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella and/or his judicial assistant(s) concerning Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 1-3.
- all public records of communications involving Judge Felix (and/or his judicial assistant(s)) about Christopher Hanson and/or Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) in the Family Law Division as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 4-5.
- all public records related to Judge Kelly Ayers' involvement in any and all disqualification scenarios, complaints, or concerns about her impartiality, honesty, and professionalism as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 6-7.

B. Due to the bad faith and efforts in support of concealment exhibited thus far, compel Defendants to provide affidavits describing search targets, methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices), to confirm completeness of production, what applications, emails, text programs searched to confirm compliance, and if applicable, justification for failing to search personal devices including text messages of Judge Ayers, her assistant, and other individuals involved in the events described above.

C. Compel Defendants to provide written explanations, with specific evidentiary and rule-based citations, for:

- The lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025.
- How "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing.
- Whether the camera recording footage on April 4, 2025, is part of an actual security system.
- Why no footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Specification on withholdings or exemptions claimed in the partial responses.
- The delays and inconsistent handling of Requests 6-8 compared to earlier requests.

D. Declare that Defendants violated Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420 through unlawful refusal, non-response to clarifications and follow-ups, refusal, and patterns of delay evidencing bias and concealment; to the extent any confidentiality determination exists, declare it invalid and vacate it under Rule 2.420(d) and (e);

E. Award attorney's fees and costs under Rule 2.420(l), §119.12 (alternative), §86.111, and common law/equity for bad faith, including enhancements;

F. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Amended Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on November 13, 2025, (with additional email service directly from Plaintiff) to the following recipients: Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at publicinfo@fljud13.org and rowlanda@fljud13.org, Gina Justice, Court Administrator at gina.justice@fljud13.org, and TCA@fljud13.org, Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org, Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud13.org, Judge Matthew Felix at famlawdiva@fljud13.org, Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org,

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

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